Minimum standards of quality for food and strict hygienic conditions for its sale are clearly outlined in the Act.

DO YOU KNOW?

A slogan **From farm to plate, make food safe** was raised on World Health Day (7th April 2015) to promote and improve food safety.

### 21.6.1 Food Quality Control Agencies

ISI, AGMARK, FPO, FCI and other health departments enforce minimum standards for the consumer products. **FCI (Food Corporation of India**) was set up in the year 1965 with the following objectives:

- Effective price support operations for safeguarding the interest of farmers.
- Distributing food grains throughout the country.
- Maintaining satisfactory levels of operational and buffer stock of food grains to ensure national security.
- Regulate the market price to provide food grains to consumers at reliable price.

**Activity 1**

Let each of the student bring any food packet (jam, juice, pickle, bread, biscuit, etc). Note down the details like name of the product, manufacturer's details, contents/ ingredients, net weight, Maximum Retail Price (MRP), date of manufacture, date of expiry/usage from the date of manufacture and standardized marks (ISI, AGMARK or FPO) printed on the label for each of the item. What is the aim of such practice?

**Food Control Agencies- Their Standardized Mark and Role in Food Safety**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ISI - (Indian Standards Institution) known as Bureau of Indian Standard (BIS) | Certifies industrial products like electrical appliances like switches, wiring cables, water heater, electric motor, kitchen appliances etc. |
| | AGMARK - (Agricultural Marking) | Certifies agricultural and livestock products like cereals, essential oils, pulses, honey, butter etc. |
| | FPO - (Fruit Process Order) | Certifies the fruit products like juice, jams, sauce, canned fruits and vegetables, pickles etc. |
| | Food Safety and Standards Authority of India | Responsible for protecting and promoting the public health through regulation and supervision of food safety. |

**Activity 2**

**Some simple techniques used to detect adulterants at home**

1. Milk: Place a drop of milk on a slanting polished surface. Pure milk flows slowly leaving a trail behind while the milk adulterated with water will flow fast without leaving a trail.



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